

Lenny Kidavi

I design and build products end to end, and I'm working toward machine learning engineering.

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SUMMARY

Computer Science student and developer in Nairobi. I design and build web products end to end, and I am working toward machine learning engineering.

EDUCATION

Catholic University of Eastern Africa (CUEA)

2025–2028 (expected)

BSc Computer Science

Lang'ata, Nairobi, Kenya

PROJECTS

SmartChama (Product · 2026)

www.smartchama.tech

Digital platform for Kenyan chama savings groups, automating M-Pesa contribution tracking, internal loans, Merry-Go-Round rotation schedules, and smart-contract verification.

Stack: Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Solidity, Ethereum

Saka (Product · 2025)

sakahapa.vercel.app

Inquiry-first marketplace connecting Nairobi households with verified local plumbers, electricians, and mechanics across 48+ estates, with zero commission and direct M-Pesa payments.

Role: Lead Founder & Full-Stack Developer

Stack: Next.js 14, Supabase, Cloudinary, Google Maps, Zustand, TanStack Query, next-pwa, Upstash Redis, Vercel

Gikuyu Translator (Client Work)

gikuyu-translate.vercel.app

Language technology experiment translating English and Kiswahili phrases into Gikuyu, built to support indigenous language preservation and learning.

Stack: Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS

HACKATHONS

Winner — Red, White & Build US–Kenya Hackathon (AI & Tech)

19 February 2026 · Nairobi, Kenya

Organized by U.S. Embassy Kenya · Prize: \$1,000

First place at the U.S. Embassy Kenya AI & Tech hackathon with SmartChama, demonstrating digital savings group management, automated M-Pesa tracking, and smart contracts.

Built: SmartChama · Team: Lenny Kidavi, Rachael, Shilla, Nanjoli

Second place — Beorchild Hackathon

2025 · Online

Organized by Beorchild

Second place finish with SmartChama at the online Beorchild hackathon.

Built: SmartChama · Team: Lenny Kidavi

SKILLS

Shipped with: TypeScript, Next.js (App Router), React, Tailwind CSS, Supabase, PostgreSQL, Solidity, Vercel, Zustand, TanStack Query

Currently learning: PyTorch, Machine Learning Systems, Applied Mathematics for ML, Model Optimization

LINKS

Portfolio: lennydev.vercel.app Fiverr: www.fiverr.com/lennynavwani

GitHub: github.com/chillyreward LinkedIn: www.linkedin.com/in/lenny-kidavi-4693ba355